TOOCHUKWU AUGUSTINE OKUTALUKWE

+43-681-841-46460 | Funfhausgasse 17-19/1, 1150 Vienna, Austria | okutalukwetoochukwu@gmail.com | LinkedIn Portfolio

RESEARCH INTEREST

Natural Language Processing
Fake News: The Impacts of Misinformation on Social Well-being
Structured and Unstructured Big Data Analysis
Human-Computer Interaction
Risks in AI and AI Regulation
Explainable and Trustworthy AI
Value-based Engineering on Information Technology

EDUCATION

Vienna University of Economics and Business, Austria 1/10/2024 – 30/06/ 2026
Course: MSc., Digital Economy
Coursework: Database Management and Analysis, Security and Privacy, IT Governance, Business Process Management, Value-based Engineering, IT Law Research Lab, Data Science and others.
Thesis: "On the Relationship between Social Norms and Artificial Intelligence: To what extent has the aggregate linguistic style of consumer complaints exhibited homogenization (reduced variance) and formalisation (shift in norms) following the widespread public release of Large Language Models?"
My thesis: Link **Note:** I am still working on publishing my thesis.
Supervisor: Professor thomas.grisold@wu.ac.at
Website: wu.ac.at
Final GPA: 2.10 (1=Excellent and 5=Fail)

Federal University of Technology Owerri, Nigeria 15/12/2015 – 03/03/2022
Course: BSc., Financial Management Technology
Website: futo.edu.ng
Award: BTech
Final GPA: 3.74/5.0 (1=Fail and 5=Excellent)
Thesis: "The Impact of Electronic Banking on Nigeria's Economy"
Supervisor: Prof. Dr C.E. Nwaimo

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Same Patient, Different Explanations? 08/05/2026 – 26/06/2026
Data Science and AI II (Vienna University of Economics and Business)
Comparative SHAP Study Across Models (XGBOOST and MLP) and Datasets (4x) in Healthcare Risk Prediction
Course Coordinator: Prof. Dr Sabrina Kirrane
Link: Shap-Consistency-in-Healthcare

Explainable-AI-XAI-using-LIME 12/12/2025 – 23/01/2026
Data Science and AI I (Vienna University of Economics and Business)
Moving beyond simple accuracy and understanding why a Deep Learning model makes specific predictions on a banking dataset.
Course Coordinator: Prof. Dr Axel Polleres
Link: Explainable-AI-XAI-using-LIME

Who Exploit AI 10/10/2025 – 20/01/2026
Research Lab (Vienna University of Economics and Business) **Research (Teamwork)**: "Understanding Individual Differences in Cooperation Toward Human vs AI Partners using SVO and Moral Expansiveness"
Course Coordinator: Prof. Dorner and Fellner-Rohling

- Participated in planning, designing and execution of the experiment using agile methods
- Deployed the oTree experiment via Heroku cloud.
- Set up and monitored experiments (new response)
- Prepared statistical and Data analysis and finally wrote a report based on findings.

Link: Who Exploit AI

SEC Filings Bulk Downloader 02/11/2025 – 18/11/2025

Personal Project: A Python script to download all 10-K and 10-Q filings for a list of companies (tickers) from 2020-01-01 to 2025-12-31 using the official SEC EDGAR API.

Cyber Security Project 15/02/2025 – 10/06/2025

Mentor Me Collective/Google

Research Analysis (Teamwork): "Detecting and Preventing Phishing Attacks on Health Workers through Network Traffic Monitoring and Detection"

Link: Detecting Phishing Attacks on Health Workers

- The project aims to protect healthcare workers, especially in underserved populations, from phishing attacks through a custom-built detection tool and secure network infrastructure.
- VirusTotal, Incident Handling Journal, Network Structure and Linux were used for the project.

Graduate Research Work 10/05/2025 – 30/06/2025

Vienna University of Economics and Business, Austria

Research Analysis (Teamwork): "World Development Project"

Course: Database Management and Analysis

Course Coordinator: Prof. Dr Axel Polleres

Link: World Development Project

- The data were subjected to Clustering, Regression, and Classification to understand the socio-economic development indicators using machine learning.
- Data source: databank.worldbank.org
- Excel and Python were used for analysis.

Graduate Research Work 10/03/2025 – 18/06/2025

Vienna University of Economics and Business, Austria

Course: Business Project Management

Course Coordinator: Prof. Dr Sabrina Kirrane

Research Project (Teamwork): "Smart, Green, and Integrated Public Transport (SIPT)"

- The Project proposal seeks to develop an intelligent, data-driven framework to support the optimisation of Vienna's public transportation network. By leveraging open data sources from Vienna Line, advanced clustering techniques, KGs, and RL.
- The initiative seeks to identify inefficiencies in the current transport system and recommend actionable, high-impact improvements.
- The objective is structured to align with the SMART methodology, ensuring accountability, transparency, and replicability throughout the 18-month project lifecycle

Graduate Research Work 14/10/2024 – 07/02/2025

Vienna University of Economics and Business, Austria

Course: Security and Privacy

Course Coordinator: Mr Khan Sajjad

Research Project Name (Teamwork): "Blockchain Data Review"

- My team and I use these 3 questions: What are you building? What can go wrong? What are you going to do about it? To address security issues in the blockchain industry, where threat actors use the platform to carry out their illicit activities.

Graduate Research Work 10/12/2024 – 16/01/2025

Vienna University of Economics and Business, Austria
Course: Marketing and Innovation
Course Coordinator: Prof. Dr C. Schamp
Project Name (Teamwork): Instafocus
Research Analysis: "The Impact of Instagram Posts on Social Well-being"
Link: Instagram-Post-Analysis

- The data were subjected to sentiment analysis to understand the social well-being of individuals based on engagement patterns.
- Data source: brightdata.com
- Excel, Power Query and Python were used for analysis.

Undergraduate Thesis 13/01/2020 – 16/08/2021
Federal University of Technology Owerri, Nigeria
Thesis: The Impact of Electronic Banking on Nigeria's Economy
Supervisor: Prof. Dr C.E. Nwaimo

- Secondary data were collected from the *Central Bank of Nigeria Statistical Bulletin.*
- The data were subjected to multiple regression, which was anchored on the innovation "Diffusion Theory and Keynesian Theory of Investment".
- The study employed the ex-post facto research design.
- Excel and SPSS were used for the analysis.
- The study discovered that the pool of electronic banking transactions affects the Nigerian economy significantly.

Undergraduate Research Assistant 14/01/2019 – 14/02/2019
Federal University of Technology Owerri, Nigeria
Research Study (Teamwork): "The Impact of FinTech on Financial Services"
Supervisor: Prof. Dr O. T. Ebringa

- Secondary data were collected from the Central Bank of Nigeria *Statistical Bulletin* and other financial sources.
- Relevant literature on the impact factors on financial services.
- Excel and SPSS were used to analyse data.
- The study discovered that fintech has a strong positive relationship with financial services.

HONOURS AND AWARDS

Certificate of Participation Erste Bank 24/06/2025
Strategy & Innovation Case Competition

Google Cloud Cyber Security Scholarship 20/06/2025
Mentor Me Collective/Google, United States

Cyber Security Scholarship 01/02/2025
Mentor Me Collective/Google, United States

Data Analysis Scholarship 01/04/2024
The American Dream Academy, United States

Financial Modelling and Valuation Analysis Scholarship 02/06/2022
Corporate Finance Institute, Vancouver, Canada

Africa Leadership Scholarship Award 19/05/2022
Africa Leadership Institute, Kenya

SOFMAT Leadership Award 24/05/2021

Best Customer Relationship Intern 07/08/2020
Fidelity Bank Nigeria

Best Course Representative 10/08/2017
The School of Management Technology, FUTO, Nigeria

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Federal University of Technology Owerri, Nigeria 07/01/2019 – 11/01/2019
Department of Financial Management Technology

- Taught a class of 60 undergraduate students on the topic "The Impact of Fintech on Financial Services".

WORK EXPERIENCE

AI Evaluator Independent Contractor | Contractor
13/06/2026 – 3/08/2026
Mercor | United States | Remote

- Used, tested and evaluated AI and LLM tools to generate tailored responses and improve automated communication workflows.
- Evaluated AI-generated outputs for accuracy, compliance and data-security requirements.
- Identified weaknesses in AI-generated responses and contributed to improvements in automated workflows.

Cloud Cyber Security Scholar | Apprenticeship 1/02/2025 – 1/02/2026
Mentor Me Collective | United States | Remote

- Configured and managed Google Cloud IAM to enforce least-privilege principles, reducing unauthorised access risk.
- Implemented Google Cloud Security Command Centre, Cloud Armour, and VPC Service Controls, reducing potential attack surfaces.
- Analysed network vulnerabilities using Nmap and examined network traffic with Wireshark to detect malicious activity.
- Investigated suspicious activity using Splunk and Wazuh dashboards and reports.
- Regularly reviewed industry standards and contributed insights on topics such as NIS2, IAM, and Zero Trust.
- Responsible for the administration of Windows and Linux IT systems. Simulated a threat against Active Directory to validate security vulnerabilities. Link: LinkedIn Post
- Simulates threats against new products using Metasploit to validate security vulnerabilities and exploitability and to perform software testing and quality assurance.

Data Analyst 01/12/2023 – 28/09/2024
MeriSkill | India | Remote

- Applied statistical techniques using R, SQL, and Excel to improve data accuracy by 30%.
- Extracted, joined, and analysed complex data from various sources using advanced SQL and R, improving overall data accuracy by 30%.
- Designed and assembled interactive dashboards and self-service tools using Power BI to deliver actionable information to stakeholders and support strategic decision-making.
- Ensured data security through role-based permissions.
- Conducted exploratory data analysis (EDA) to improve data-driven decision-making.

Data Analyst 10/01/2022 – 27/07/2024
Emmy Frank Nigeria Limited | Nigeria

- Implemented audit process, reducing refund fraud by 30%, effectively controlling variances and saving costs using Python.
- Implemented database security best practices using the NIST Framework.
- Performed data analysis on customer transactions, improving accuracy by 20% through actionable insights using Python.
- Streamlined workflows, enhancing data integration and reporting.
- Collected, analysed, and interpreted large datasets related to refund transactions and customer behaviour, which provided actionable insights that reduced refund fraud by 30%

Customer Support Analyst | Internship 01/08/2019 – 01/09/2020
Fidelity Bank Plc | Lagos | Nigeria

- Provided cybersecurity awareness training to customers, improving security compliance.
- Boosted product sales by 80%, exceeding bank KPIs through innovative marketing strategies.
- Researched and compiled tailored monthly analytics and reports for mid-level senior management with Excel and IBM SPSS software.
- Attained the "Intern of the Year Award" in 2019.
- Resolved customers' complaints by identifying problems and taking appropriate corrective action, increasing the client retention ratio by 50%.
- Increased customer satisfaction by 15% through proactive engagement.

LEADERSHIP EXPERIENCE

Mentor Me Collective 15/05/2025 – 07/06/2025
Cyber Security Project: "Detecting and Preventing Phishing Attacks on Health Workers through Network Traffic Monitoring and Detection"

- Led and collaborated effectively on our project, ensuring clear documentation and professional communication throughout the project.

Digital Economy, WU 10/05/2025 – 30/06/2025
Database Management and Analysis Project: "World Development Project"

- Led and collaborated effectively on our project, ensuring clear documentation, data sourcing, cleaning, and transformation of data for analysis. Ensured professional communication throughout the project.

National Youth Services Camp 4/11/2022 – 23/11/2022
Room Leader:

- I was responsible for the day-to-day running of their room.
- Maintained a high-quality, stimulating learning environment.
- Supervised Cor members and imparted their knowledge and skills to others.

Department of Financial Management Technology 15/12/2015 – 20/06/2017
Course Representative:

- Volunteered and led a class of 100 students by taking responsibility and acting as a liaison between students and lecturers and professors.
- Represented student colleagues' views at meetings by participating in the Staff-Student Consultative Committee.
- Sorted out students' thoughts and opinions on their study program and wider learning experience.

PRESENTATIONS

Research Presentation 26/06/2025

Same Patient, Different Explanations? "Comparative SHAP Study Across Models and Datasets in Healthcare Risk Prediction
Project Description: My teammate and I presented a systematic, empirical test to evaluate SHAP's (SHapley Additive Explanations) consistency across ML models in healthcare.

Research Presentation 08/05/2025
Erste Bank/SICC Competition: "Cracking the Code: Building Genz's Go-To Investment Platform"
Project Description: Pitch a strategic way in which Genz would adopt an investment platform, and what could attract them to invest.
Position in Competition: My team and I came 4th in the Competition.
Location: Vienna University of Economics and Business (WU).

Research Presentation 24/06/2025
Value-Based Engineering Presentation: "Redesigning Bible Chat App with Value-Based Engineering"
Location: Vienna University of Economics and Business (WU).

Research Presentation 18/06/2025
Business Project Management Presentation: "Smart, green and integrated public transport (SIPT)"
Location: Vienna University of Economics and Business (WU).

Research Presentation 22/06/2025
Transformation Management Presentation: "Towards a Financial Life Company:
Strategic Recommendations for Erste Bank Group"
Location: Vienna University of Economics and Business (WU).

Research Presentation 23/01/2025
Marketing and Innovation Presentation: "Instafocus: The impact of social Media on the well-being of individuals"
Location: Vienna University of Economics and Business (WU).

Research Presentation 05/12/2024
Digital Marketing Paper Review Presentation: "Analysis of online position auctions for search engine marketing"
Location: Vienna University of Economics and Business (WU).

Research Presentation 26/05/2019
Presentation: "The Impact of FinTech on Financial Services"
Location: School of Management Conference Hall, FUTO, Owerri, Nigeria.

Hutz Price Presentation 11/12/2018
Presentation: "The Agro Estate".
Location: Student Union Government Secretariat, FUTO, Owerri, Nigeria.

CONFERENCES AND SEMINARS

Workshop 04/10/2021 – 08/10/2021
Lagos, Nigeria
"Get into the African Fintech ecosystem", Fintech Week 2021, Lagos, Nigeria, Hands-on training on the impact of Fintech in Financial Services.

Seminar/Webinar 09/09/2021 – 10/09/2021
Lagos, Nigeria
"Lagos Blockchain and Future Tech Conference"

Seminar/Webinar 13/05/2019 – 15/05/2021
Imo, Nigeria

"A New Global Initiative for Youths" Student Leadership Summit, Federal University of Technology, Owerri.

VOLUNTEERING

Volunteer at Meaningful Work 01/07/2022 – 12/12/2023
Vancouver, Canada.

- Aid in improving start-up companies by providing proper financial oversight.
- Create a strategic plan and ensure that it's followed.
- Ensure legal compliance and ethical integrity.

Volunteer at The Female Media Network 11/02/2019 – 10/12/2021
Imo, Nigeria.

- Taught Young African women Tech skills through the use of Microsoft Excel, SPSS, and TradingView to become financially independent.

Volunteer at Enactus Futo Chapter 04/02/2016 – 12/08/2018
Imo, Nigeria.

- Led a team of 15 students in redefining waste products for community use.

PROFESSIONAL AFFILIATION

Member, Financial Management Technology 01/02/2016 – 10/08/2021

Member, School of Management Technology 01/02/2016 – 10/08/2021

CORE SKILLS & TOOLS

Tools: Python, SQL, R, Bash, Splunk (SIEM), Suricata, VirusTotal, Nmap, Wireshark, Incident Handling Journal
Framework: GDPR, ISO 27001, NIST CSF, CSA CCM
Data Analysis & Reporting: Power BI, Microsoft Excel, Tableau, Microsoft 365, KPI Dashboard
Data Science and AI: Classification, Clustering, Regression, LIME, RAG, SHAP
Network Security: Linux, Firewall Configuration
Information Security Management: Risk Analysis, Threat Detection, Vulnerability Assessment
Technical Proficiency: Secure SDLC, Network Security, Identity & Access Management
Communication: Technical Documentation, Cross-functional Collaboration, Stakeholder Engagement
Soft Skills: Initiative, Social Fluency, Analytical Thinking, Global Collaboration, Problem-Solving, Requirement Gathering, Attention to Details

LANGUAGE SKILLS

English: Proficient levels in Listening, Speaking, Reading, and Writing.
German (A1.1): Beginner level in Listening, Speaking, and Reading
French (A1.1): Beginner levels in Listening, Speaking, and Reading.

PROFESSIONAL COURSES AND CERTIFICATES

Google Cloud Cyber Security 20/06/2025
Mentor Me Collective/Google

Google Cyber Security 01/02/2025
Mentor Me Collective/Google

Google Data Analysis Professional 01/04/2024
The American Dream Academy

Financial Modelling and Valuation Analyst 31/07/2022
Corporate Finance Institute, Vancouver, Canada.

Foundation of Python 15/06/2022
Udacity, California, US.

Cross-Cultural Communication 31/07/2020
William Davidson Institute, Michigan, United States.

General Computing 30/10/2010
Cubiz Computer Training, Makurdi, Nigeria.

RECOMMENDATIONS

Associate Prof
Name: **PD Dr Sabrina Kirrane**
Email: sabrina.kirrane@wu.ac.at
Department: Digital Economy
School: Vienna University of Economics and Business/ Institute for Complex Networks
Relationship: Business Project Management/Data Science and AI Professor

Full Professor
Name: Prof. Thomas Grisold
Email: thomas.grisold@wu.ac.at
Department: Digital Economy
School: Vienna University of Economics and Business/ Information Systems and Applied AI
Relationship: Master's Thesis Supervisor

Assistant Professor
Name: Professor Djordje Djurica
Email: Djordje.Djurica@wu.ac.at
Department: Digital Economy
School: Vienna University of Economics and Business/ Institute for Information Systems and Society
Relationship: Business Process Management

Assistant Lecturer
Name: Khan Sajjad MSc
Email: sajjad.khan@wu.ac.at
Department: Digital Economy
School: Vienna University of Economics and Business
Relationship: Security and Privacy Lecturer

Senior Lecturer
Name: Prof. Dr. C.E Nwaimo
Phone number: (+234) 08036305179
Email: nwaimo@futo.edu.ng and Brochilaka013@gmail.com
Department: Financial Management Technology
School: Federal University of Technology, Owerri, Imo, Nigeria
Relationship: Bachelor Thesis Supervisor

Full Professor
Name: Prof. Dr. C.U Ejiogu
Phone number: (+234) 07034269849
Email: uzoamaka.chris-ejiogu@futo.edu.ng
Department: Financial Management Technology
School: Federal University of Technology, Owerri, Imo, Nigeria.
Relationship: Assistant Bachelor Thesis Supervisor